

2020-21 REPORT

In alignment with our objective to empower women, create a safe space for them and make them economically self-reliant, this year we took different initiatives with response to the Covid-19 crisis.



About Red Brigade Lucknow



In 2011, Usha Vishwakarma and 15 other young girls from Madiyaon, Lucknow started a 'Voice Against Sexual Violence' by establishing Red Brigade Lucknow.

One of the main strengths of the organization is that it employed a combination of self-defense techniques, and real-life experiences shared by survivors of sexual violence, along with self-defense techniques from different countries, specifically tailored for protection against sexual violence to design a 'self-defense training' named "Nishastra". Over 1,57,000 girls and women have been trained with Nishastra, with 56,000 from the CAVACH Mission of the Uttar Pradesh Government and the remainder from seven other states.

<https://redbrigade-lucknow.org/>

March 2020 COVID-19 Crisis Interventions:

- Ration kits and daily use items were distributed to about 20000 people.
- Distributed 25000 cooked food packets.
- Distributed 20,000 milk and porridge packets to 14,500 children.
- To ensure that relief material is delivered into the hands of women of beneficiary households, maximum participation women was ensured in the project.
- Counselling was conducted for many women survivors of domestic violence as there was a sudden surge in the number of cases during the lockdown.



Ration was distributed to families predominantly comprising Muslims in many areas of Lucknow such as Madiyaon, Badi Jugauli, Gomtinagar, Khargapur, Gomtinagar Extension, Alambagh, Dubagga, Para, Daliganj, Khadra, Sarojini Nagar, KKCBhedimandi, and Chowk. It was also ensured that relief materials reached the hands of women.

The recipients primarily consisted of individuals who rely on daily wage labor and engage in manual work within the slums for sustenance. Many hails from neighboring districts of Lucknow, including Gonda, Bahraich, Sitapur, and Hardoi. Ration distribution was also extended to families originating from Chhattisgarh.

- **5 April to 15 June** – Cooked food was given to 20,000 people in Lucknow's Garib Basti. In these, women, children and elderly people received food.
- **April 12 to June 10** - Milk and porridge were distributed to 250 small children in Chhoti Jugauli colony of Gomtinagar. Here some pregnant women and sick people also received these packets.
- **Sanitary pads** distributed to needy girls of Madiyaon, Jugauli and Nagwamau of Lucknow.
- **First aid** and **medicines** were made available to 150 people in Daliganj, Madiyaon and Jugauli and other villages.



Programs conducted in October



The self-defence workshop for girls, facilitated by the “Aavahan Project” of Shri Ram Charitable Trust, showcased remarkable enthusiasm and energy among the female students.



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December Initiative: “Damini ki yaad Me“ (In the memory of Damini)

- A program named “Raat ka Ujala” was organized by Red Brigade Lucknow in collaboration with Lucknow Metro to foster a more harmonious society.
- The Red Brigade Lucknow group staged street dramas, portraying various facets of society, to enlighten girls about the importance of fearlessness and safety in society.
- As a tribute to Damini's memory, 1001 lamps were lit to honor all those who have suffered similar fates.
- Another program named “Ek Chai Mahila Ke Samman Mei” was also arranged. Lucknow Metro MD Shri Kumar Keshav, along with Anju, Abhishek, Nancy, and other colleagues, graced the event with their presence.



February 2021: Economic Self-reliance of Women

In the village of Badi Jugauli in Gomti Nagar, Red Brigade Lucknow inaugurated its sewing Skill Training Centre. Twenty-five girls will comprise the inaugural cohort, undergoing comprehensive training over a period of three months. Qualified female trainers will guide them through their chosen areas of expertise, laying the foundation for a future of independence and self-sufficiency.



Prerna Yatra (National Women's Day 13 February)



This year, on February 13, 2021, Red Brigade Lucknow extended the celebration of National Women's Day to every village in Lucknow. Over the course of their journey spanning from February 13 to March 2, 2021, they traversed one million meters, engaging with roughly 100 villages and impacting approximately 10,000 women and girls.

Under the auspices of National Women's Day (One Million Meter March), Red Brigade Sarojini embarked on a mission to engage with women and girls in villages, discussing topics ranging from Women's Day and women's history to self-defense techniques and digital literacy, among other societal issues. In this initiative, training sessions on self-defense skills were organized in various locations such as Nagar, Mohanlal Ganj, Gosaiganj, Kakori, Malihabad, Mall, and Bakshika Talab Block, drawing the participation of approximately 5000 women and girls.

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